



Optum
VA CCN Region 3
3237 Airport Road
La Crosse, WI 54603

March 30, 2026

The Honorable Ashley Moody
Attn: Terri Finger
201 South Orange Avenue
Suite 350
Orlando, FL 32801

Dear Senator Moody,

Thank you for contacting Optum. We appreciate you bringing this matter to our attention on behalf of Mr. Steven Barden regarding his concerns with potential Fraud, Waste, and Abuse (FWA) as well as potential quality-of-care (PQI) concerns, related to services provided by Dr. James Green.

Optum takes any potential health care FWA very seriously. Optum's Payment Integrity (PI) Department confirmed receipt of a potential FWA report in September 2024. However, Optum's PI Department only shares its findings with those individuals directly involved in their investigation.

Furthermore, Optum takes all quality-of-care concerns very seriously. Optum's goal for all Veterans is to receive exemplary care in the community, and we sincerely apologize for Mr. Barden's experience. Optum's Clinical Quality (CQ) Department confirmed receipt of two (2) separate PQI Referral Forms related to this concern on March 27, 2024, and September 10, 2024. The CQ program is designed to identify potential quality-of-care issues, develop interventions to resolve identified problems, and provide ongoing monitoring of the quality-of-care and treatment of Veterans. Every potential quality issue received by the CQ Department is thoroughly investigated. If a quality-of-care issue is confirmed, Optum takes all necessary and appropriate actions to remediate the issue. Optum's CQ review is thorough, with a focus on the identification and resolution of patient safety and quality-of-care issues while working within the applicable regulations governing confidentiality. Sharing information and determinations related to our quality-of-care reviews is limited in accordance with 38 C.F.R § 5705. Included in this regulation are confidentiality requirements, which govern how the details of the review may be released. As a result, CQ's findings are only shared with those individuals directly involved in the quality review process.

Due to privacy and confidentiality requirements, no prior communication has been issued regarding the FWA and PQI concerns submitted by Mr. Barden, and this letter will serve as the only formal communication regarding either investigation. Please know Optum properly reports all findings related to both FWA and PQI investigations to the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) as contractually required.

Lastly, Optum's Technology Department confirmed that Mr. Barden's Optum VA Community Care Network (CCN) Veteran Portal account is active and does not appear locked as of March 27, 2026. Should Mr. Barden experience any issues accessing the portal in the future, he may contact VA's Veteran Customer Service Center at (877) 881-7618 for technology support.



VA Community Care Network (VA CCN)

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On behalf of Optum, thank you for the opportunity to address Mr. Barden's concerns. It is an honor and privilege to serve the Veterans and all VA CCN providers in Florida.

Very Respectfully,

Kelly R.
Congressional Inquiry Department
Optum